

New Career Services Platform: UT Dallas is moving from Handshake to 12twenty

+

Career Fairs

[UT Dallas](#) > [University Career Center](#) > [Career Resource Library](#) > **Career Fairs**

On This Page

Video Guide
Before the Fair
During the Fair
After the Fair
Virtual Career Fairs
Elevator Pitch

Why Attend a Career Fair?

Career fairs connect you directly with employers, recruiters, and alumni professionals. They are valuable for exploring companies, learning about roles, and building your network even if you are not job hunting yet. They are also a great place to make connections that can lead to informational interviews or future opportunities.

Need help preparing your pitch or resume?

[SCHEDULE AN APPOINTMENT](#)

Video Guide



Career Resource Library: Career Fair Success
UTD Career Center



Watch on

IN-PERSON CAREER FAIRS VIDEO OVERVIEW

IN-PERSON CAREER FAIRS VIDEO GUIDE

VIRTUAL CAREER FAIRS VIDEO GUIDE

Preparing for the Fair

Before the Fair

- Register through 12twenty and view the list of attending employers.
- Research top companies: their mission, culture, recent news, current opportunities, etc.
- Prepare your elevator pitch: your name, major, experience, and goals.
- Print 15-20 copies of your resume for in-person fairs.
- Update your resume and test your tech for virtual sessions.
- Go in with an open mind—many companies hire for a variety of majors and roles.

What to Bring (In-Person)

- Resumes, notepad, pen, and a folder or slim bag
- Comfortable, professional attire and walking shoes
- Confidence and a firm handshake

What to Prepare (Virtual)

- Join early to test your audio and video

- Use a quiet space with a clean, neutral background
- Dress professionally (from top to bottom in case you need to stand)
- Be ready to upload and/or copy & paste your resume or LinkedIn in the chat
- Make sure to arrive on time and do not be late.
- Maintain eye contact with your camera.

During the Fair

- Introduce yourself with a clear and confident elevator pitch.
- Ask informed questions based on your research.
- Offer your resume before any interruptions or distractions occur, or follow up with it if it is a virtual meeting.
- Smile, make eye contact, stay engaged, and ask about next steps.
- Use the fair to build connections, not to just find open jobs and internships.
- Consider offering to visit the recruiter in-person or virtually for a longer conversation.
- Remember to thank the recruiter for their time as the conversation is ending and ask for their business card.

After the Fair

- Send a thank you email within 24-48 hours.
- Mention something specific you discussed with the recruiter.
- Connect with the recruiter on LinkedIn and express interest in staying in touch.
- If the recruiter gave you specific instructions, be sure to follow them exactly and don't wait to submit your resume/application.
- Even if there is not a current opening at the company, you can always request to do an informational interview to stay in touch with the employer.

Tips for Standing Out

- Approach confidently and be conversational. An effective approach as you visit each table is to be prepared with something to say, and to exude confidence and friendliness.
- Let your resume highlight your impact, not just your tasks.
- Stay organized: track who you met and when you followed up.

Virtual Career Fairs

Virtual career fairs give you the opportunity to meet recruiters and other employers through video sessions. By attending a virtual fair instead of an in-person fair, there is no need to wait in line to talk to recruiters. You can secure your spot to meet with employers you are interested in by signing up for specific session times.

There are two types of virtual sessions:

Group Sessions

During a group session, you will join other students to meet recruiters and other employees at the organization at the same time. You can learn about job opportunities, company culture, and more. You will also have opportunities to ask your own questions.

One-on-One Sessions

One-on-one sessions are an opportunity to chat directly with a recruiter about jobs and internships. Recruiters that want to meet with you will be able to invite you to attend a virtual session with them.

Recruiters will likely review your profile before a session, so be sure to update your 12twenty profile with your role and location preferences as well as skills, organizations, and work experience.

How to Find Virtual Fairs on 12twenty

There are a few different ways to find virtual fairs and events for students on 12twenty:

- **Event recommendations:** Just like job recommendations, 12twenty will recommend upcoming virtual events for you based on your profile and interests.
- **Events page:** To see a full list of upcoming events, click the Events tab on your 12twenty dashboard. You can use filters to narrow down events by date and whether they are a Career Fair and Virtual. You can also search for events using keywords.
- **Employer pages:** You can view which upcoming events an employer is attending or hosting when you visit their page.

When you click on a virtual fair page, you'll see which employers will be attending and a list of their sessions and speakers. You can also filter the list of all employers by location, industry, and more.

Registering for a Virtual Fair

To claim your spot at a virtual fair, click the Register button on the top right corner of the page. When you register for a virtual fair, you will see a list of sessions you can sign up for with each employer. To claim your spot at a virtual fair, click the Register button on the top right corner of the page. This page also includes filters and a search bar, so you can narrow down the sessions and find the ones you want to sign up for.

Elevator Pitch

An elevator pitch is a short professional introduction given to employers intended to focus on your education, skill set, background, and interests. This statement should be brief (and last no longer than an elevator ride, hence the name), falling somewhere between 30 seconds to 2 minutes. Elevator pitches can be used during interviews, career fairs, and networking events.

What to Include

You should focus on your relevant skills, major, school year, certifications, and relevant experience. You can also include your professional goals, accomplishments, research experience, and projects. Make sure that your elevator pitch is specific to the position you are interested in.

Here are steps for creating your elevator pitch:

- Start your elevator pitch by introducing yourself (name, school, major, school year).
- Provide a brief summary of what you do (background, key strengths, relevant skills, and work experience).
- Explain what you are seeking (internship, full-time job, request to connect on LinkedIn, etc.)
- End you elevator pitch by stating what you want to happen next (keep it simple).

Once you create your elevator pitch, practice with friends, family, classmates, or a career advisor.

Ace Your Elevator Pitch

- Speak naturally and slow it down
- Use one pitch for most, but not all, occasions; tailor it whenever you can
- Make it easy to understand
- Make sure it is brief, persuasive, and confident but not boastful

Sample Pitch

“Hi, I’m *[Name]*, a junior Neuroscience major at UTD. I recently completed a lab internship where I developed skills in data analysis and qPCR. I’m looking for a research assistant role—can you share what qualifications your team looks for?”

The University of Texas at Dallas

University Career Center

Student Services Building 3.300
800 W. Campbell Road
Richardson, Texas 75080-3021

972-883-2943

EVENTS

- OCT 6

UCC - Comet Trek (Employer Site Visit) with Medpace
- OCT 7

UCC- Deep Ellum Foundation Tabling
- OCT 7

UCC: CVS Health Information Session
- OCT 8

UCC- Teach for America Tabling
- OCT 8

UCC: Fifth Third Bank- Panel and Networking Event



UT Dallas University
Career Center

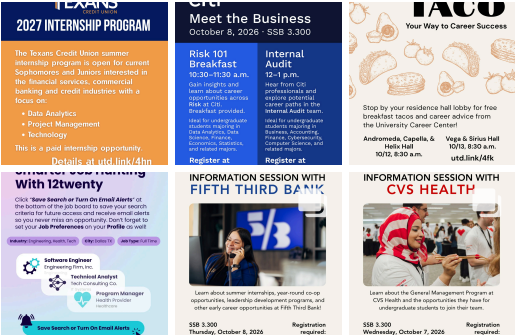
@utdcareercenter

429
Posts

7.3K
Followers

470
Following

Follow



Load more

Privacy Policy

© The University of Texas at Dallas